

them you have a bachelor's degree anymore, so you should not bankrupt yourself trying to obtain something that is not going to set you apart. Adding internships, jobs, volunteering, and extra-curriculars to your resume can provide you with real-world experience that future employers may find more attractive than your degree.

You need to weigh your future salary against the cost of school. Compare your expected salary to the loans you are going to take out. If you plan to be a high school teacher like myself, you need to run away from a potential debt of \$75,000. If your college degree will land you a high-paying job, \$75,000 may not be too much of a burden. If you plan on majoring in a field that is not typically high-paying, it may take you a lifetime to pay off a hefty student loan.

There is no guarantee you are going to like your dream school. I know many people who have gone to their dream school only to find out they hate their dream school. I have a friend who went to a very expensive out-of-state school for two years before transferring home to a public university. Unfortunately, dream schools do not offer you a refund just because you don't like them. So my buddy now has to make monthly payments to the dream school for the next ten years, even though his degree is from a different school.

Your college experience is primarily going to be shaped by the people you meet. Whether or not you have a great time in college will mostly be determined by the friends you make, mentors you meet, and activities you get involved in. You can get the "college experience" at just about any school; there is no need to take on crippling debt to get it. Going to a football game at University A and a football game at University B might be a bit different, but is that difference worth \$75,000?